during the fighting, which lasted two days. Among those killed was Maulana Abdul Rashid Ghazi, one of the two leaders of the Lal Masjid. The other leader, his brother Maulana Abdul Aziz Ghazi, was arrested while trying to escape disguised in a burqa.

FATA erupted and over 300 people were killed in the weeks following the storming of the Lal Masjid.[69] Within a year the insurgency, in the form of high-profile terrorist attacks, had spread to Punjab province. However, FATA and the NWFP continued to absorb the lion's share of the violence. The TTP officially united in December 2007 under the leadership of Baitullah Mehsud, with commanders operating in each of Pakistan's seven tribal agencies as well as a number of districts in the NWFP. It was an umbrella organization rather than a hierarchical one, and disputes continued to exist among the various actors operating under its banner. Nonetheless, Baitullah succeeded in bringing greater unity to the movement before he was killed by a US drone strike in August 2009. His death created temporary confusion and competition among TTP commanders, but did little to slow the insurgency. Nor was the military able to dislodge permanently militants from their strongholds in the region. After launching an incursion into the Swat Valley in spring 2008 to clear it of militants and another into the Bajaur tribal agency, the army deployed over 40,000 troops into South Waziristan in October 2009. Although it proved able to clear these areas in the short term, consolidating gains and keeping insurgents at bay proved far more challenging. This contributed to the army's reluctance to expand counter-insurgency efforts into North Waziristan, as did the fact that the Haqqani Network based there remained a useful proxy in Afghanistan.

Pakistan's policy of separating good jihadis from bad meant that it was both a supporter and victim of jihadism. On one end of the spectrum were Lashkar, the Haqqani Network and the Taliban. They did not attack the state and instead directed their violence beyond Pakistan's borders. In return, they continued to receive preferential treatment. Al-Qaeda, the TTP, Ilyas Kashmiri's 313 Brigade and the Punjabi Taliban [a network of militants who formerly belonged to JeM, LeJ and SSP] were on the other end, actively at war with the state, with a mélange of other actors at various points in the middle. However, what all of these outfits shared in common was involvement in Afghanistan, which created the conditions for increased collaboration and cross-pollination. Thus, the state was actively supporting